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While Google has always been good at adapting and innovating new products/services, it drastically failed with the launch of Google Glass during COVID-19. It was an ambitious wearable tech project by Google, but it failed due to a poor product market fit. The device faced criticism for privacy concerns, limited functionality, and high cost. These issues led to low adoption rates and negative public perception, causing Google to halt consumer sales.

Google Glass



7. Flawed Business Model

A flawed business model fails to generate sustainable revenue, efficiently manage costs, or scale effectively. Startups with such models often rely too heavily on external funding, struggle with operational inefficiencies, or miscalculate market demand. While early growth may look promising, the absence of a strong financial foundation makes long-term survival difficult.

Consider Peppertap, once a promising Indian grocery delivery startup. It expanded aggressively with deep discounts to acquire customers but failed to establish a profitable unit economics model. The company depended on third-party retailers for inventory, leading to supply inconsistencies and logistical challenges. With high customer acquisition costs and intense competition from BigBasket, Grofers, and Amazon, Peppertap couldn't sustain its operations. Despite raising over \$50 million in funding, the company shut down in 2016 due to an unsustainable cost structure and lack of differentiation.

